Welcome to Winchester Close.



All about us...



Hi there and welcome to Winchester Close!

Moving and settling into a new home can be challenging, especially when you're away from your family and friends. This Young Person's Guide is a helpful handbook that explains some

of the expectations for you and us.

We recommend reading this guide before you come to stay, as it can help you settle in and understand what to expect. We'll answer any questions you have before moving in and can discuss the guide with you once you arrive.

We understand that moving can be emotional for some young people; they may feel frightened, angry, happy, or relieved. The adults will talk to you about your feelings and support you during your time at Winchester Close.

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Age:

Welcome to our cozy home.



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Winchester Close is in the Bracebridge Heath area of Lincoln, a busy city with many fun activities like bowling, cinema, crazy golf, trampoline parks, roller skating, skate parks, and climbing walls.

If you haven't visited the home, you'll meet the adults, tour the house and gardens, and be shown to your new bedroom. The adults will help you settle in and personalise your room.

We'll explain the house rules and what you can expect from the adults.

You must participate in all fire drills, whether practice or not, as they're ***important*** for your safety.



We'd like to take a photo of you with your permission, which will be on your paperwork.

House Expectations & Rules
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Rewards & Consequences
We acknowledge and celebrate good behaviour and positive achievements at Winchester Close. Rewards can include an activity or leisure trip, a takeaway meal, a cinema trip, etc. You can discuss your reward with the adults. You can also work towards bigger activities and more expensive items.

Be Healthy : Be Happy

Upon arrival at Winchester Close, you'll be registered with a local doctor, dentist, and optician, and we'll arrange your first appointment. We'll support you in accessing these services while you stay with us.

Medication: Keep all prescribed medication in the locked medicine cabinet in the office. Adults will give you any medication.

Mealtimes:



We eat at regular times as a family and you'll be asked for weekly menu suggestions. Everyone helps out at mealtimes, including washing up and clearing away. The kitchen is open all day for drinks, fresh fruit, and healthy snacks. If you have dietary needs, like allergies, vegetarianism, or Halal meat, we'll ensure they're met. **Smoking is illegal until you're 18. If you smoke, we'll discuss it with your social worker.** Sleep is important for growth, repair, and recharging. We'll discuss your bedtime and agree on an appropriate time for your age. Weekend bedtime extensions can be earned for positive behaviour.



If you struggle to sleep or settle in the evening, don't worry! We're here to help you establish a routine that suits you. This may involve settling time with an adult or taking a warm bath before bed. We'll ask you what works best. Sleep is crucial for our mental and physical health.

STAYING SAFE

Fire Drills and Emergencies

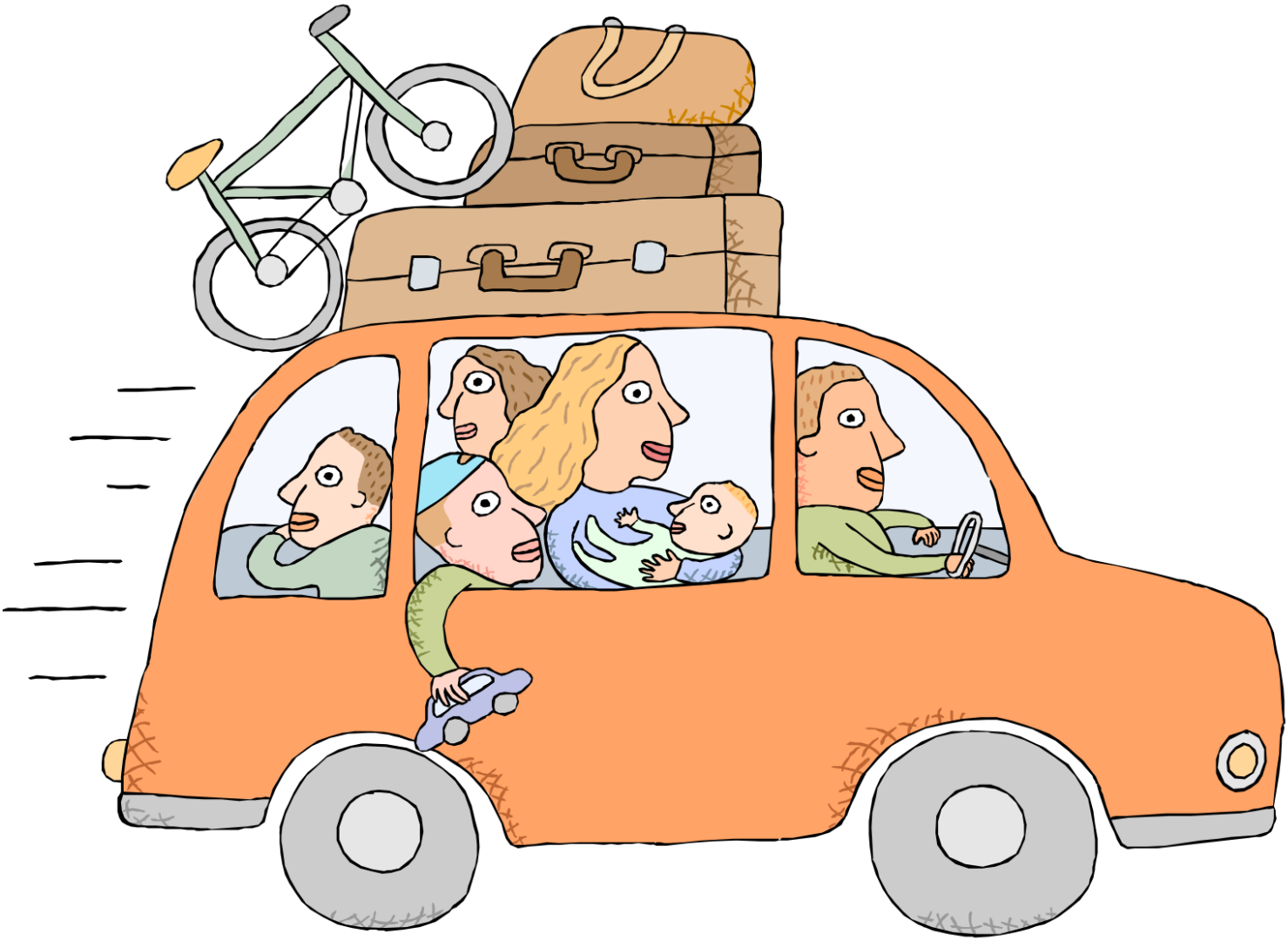


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The adults will ensure the home's safety. Doors are locked with twist locks on the inside, allowing you to exit. This prevents unauthorised entry. If you suspect someone shouldn't be on the grounds, inform an adult immediately. Don't approach or speak to them yourself.

Visitors are only allowed with your social worker's and the home's adults' permission. All visitors are arranged beforehand. Please behave when a resident has a visitor.

Transport



Winchester Close has one company vehicle for transporting residents to education, activities, appointments, and home visits. Residents with education and health take priority.

Leaving the building:
Winchester Close provides high-level supervision to ensure residents' safety. Unless agreed by a social worker or parent, no one can leave the home without permission. If you go missing, we'll take steps to ensure your safety. When you return, we'll discuss your actions and any concerns you may have. You can talk to an advocate if you prefer.

Bullying and Discriminating Behaviour



We value diversity and don't tolerate discrimination. Any negative behaviour is recorded and discussed with an adult. Racial abuse and discrimination are criminal offences and will be dealt with, which may involve your Social Worker or the police. If you're worried about bullying or discrimination, talk to an adult immediately. **We'll** treat you as an individual and understand your likes and dislikes.



We'll help you with things you're good at, like sports or art. We can help you find local clubs to join and make new friends. Swimming's an important life skill that keeps you fit and fun. If you can't swim, we can arrange lessons for you. You'll only be taken swimming to places with lifeguards.



If you have any activities you'd like to try, tell an adult and they'll arrange it for you to have a go.

Education is important and a legal requirement until you're 18. We don't provide formal education at home, so you'll be expected to attend the education provision chosen for you daily.

We want to help you achieve your best. Adults will help you with homework if you need it. A weekly planner will help you see what you'll be doing and when.



You'll have a keyworker who'll look after you and make sure you're well-cared for at Winchester Close. Once you've met the adults, you can choose an extra keyworker. All the adults work together to make up your personal key team. You'll have one-on-one time with your keyworker at least once a week to discuss problems, look at your placement and set goals. All the adults in the home will also complete keywork sessions with you.



We understand your home and lifestyle are important to you, and we want you to feel at home at Winchester Close. We'll help you keep your identity, culture, and language important to you. If religion is important to you, we'll find the right place of worship and ensure you have access to your faith settings. We'll also provide the specific food, skin, or hair products you need. We'll respect your wishes and ask for your help in ensuring we provide the right care.



Residents' meetings are held at least once a month, giving residents a chance to share their thoughts, wishes, and opinions. Important discussions from adult meetings will be discussed

with residents. Residents are encouraged to participate in various ways, including writing minutes, bringing agenda items, or discussing topics they'd like to discuss.



Your bedroom is your personal space, so please take care of it. If you want your bedroom decorated, let an adult know your ideas and they'll pass them on to the maintenance team.

Young people shouldn't enter each other's bedrooms.

Saturday is pocket money day. If you clean and tidy your bedroom, you'll get your money. If you don't, it'll go into a separate savings account for larger items, agreed with the key team.

Each week, £ is put away for clothes you need while at Winchester Close. Clothes are bought with adult guidance to ensure they're appropriate for your age and the time of year. You'll also receive £ a week for toiletries.

The adults will help you open a bank or savings account if you want to start saving.



Personal telephone calls



We'll ensure you can contact family, friends, and important people, but these contacts must have your parents' or social workers' agreement to keep you safe. You'll have a landline phone for private calls. Adults will store contact details so you don't lose them if your phone breaks or you lose them.

You can't use the company mobile phone.

Personal mobile phones are allowed at Winchester Close with your social worker's agreement. Generally, young people don't keep mobiles in their bedrooms overnight unless agreed as part of your placement plan. Mobile phones will be kept securely locked in the office for overnight charging.

We understand that you may struggle to control your behaviour, especially when stressed, anxious, or angry. It may be difficult to walk away from upsetting situations. Adults will support you to take control, but as a last resort and to keep you safe, they may use physical intervention. We'll discuss this more when you move in, but they'll never physically restrain you unless it's absolutely necessary.

We welcome you and hope your stay will be positive. We value your comments to help us improve your care.

If you want to make a complaint, you have the right to do so about anything to do with your care, situation, or anything else.

There are different ways to make a complaint and different people you can talk to.

YOU CAN TALK TO: -

If you're concerned about a child's safety at Winchester Close, you can contact the following:

- The Manager or any other adult member of the team.
- Your Social Worker.
- Your advocate.
- The NSPCC on 0800 800 5000 or 0800 056 0566.
- Childline on 0800 1111.
- Our OFSTED inspector at Ofsted National Business Unit, Piccadilly Gate, Store Street, Manchester, M1 2WD. Call 03001231231 for our special OFSTED number.
- The Children's Rights Commissioner, Dame Rachel De Souza**, at childrenscommissioner.gov.uk, 020 7783 8330, or by writing to the Office of the Children's Commissioner (OCC).**



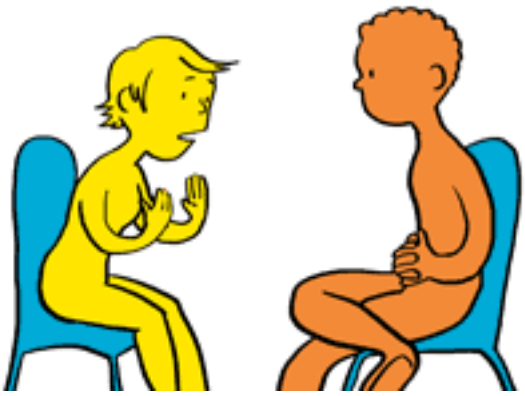
Dame Rachel de Souza

The Office of the Children's Commissioner
Sanctuary Buildings
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Any complaint you make to the home's adults will be dealt with promptly and investigated thoroughly. You'll be kept informed of the progress within a maximum of 14 days.

In some cases, involving your social worker and other professionals may be necessary.

WHAT IS AN ADVOCATE?



What does an advocate do?

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